Year 5 English | A Weekly Outdoor Lesson?

Learn and notice | Represent and answer an opposing view

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Name: _____ Date: _____

Learning intention

I can describe an opposing view fairly and respond with a relevant explanation or practical condition.

Model: Learning in the School Garden

Our class should use the school garden for a planned science lesson when conditions are suitable. Observing a real place could give us details that are difficult to notice in a picture.

For example, students could compare leaves and record where insects are found. These observations would give us specific examples to discuss back in class.

A teacher might reasonably worry that an outdoor space makes it harder for students to hear instructions. That concern matters. A small group area, clear boundaries and a short briefing before going outside could help the teacher manage the lesson. If conditions were unsuitable, the class could stay indoors.

Outdoor learning should be planned carefully, with the location chosen to suit the lesson rather than used simply for a change of scenery.

Writing detective

1. What reason supports the outdoor lesson?
2. How does the writer show the concern is reasonable?
3. Which conditions directly respond to that concern?

Notice and explain

A. People against outdoor lessons just hate fun.
B. Some teachers may worry that bad weather interrupts planned lessons.
Which represents a reasonable concern fairly? Explain.

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Think and plan | Represent and answer an opposing view

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Your writing task

Write to the principal about a weekly outdoor lesson. Explain your position with two developed reasons, address an opposing view fairly and finish with a conclusion. Do not invent survey results.

Position and purpose

Should schools have a weekly outdoor lesson? Write to the principal. Agree, disagree or qualify.

Develop your strongest reason

Explain why it matters and provide a specific illustration.

Add a different reason

Explain it rather than repeating your first point.

Opposing view and response

State a reasonable concern accurately. Explain a response or practical limit.

Conclusion

Summarise why your proposal remains worthwhile under your stated conditions.

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Write your draft | Use your own ideas

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Your turn

Write to the principal about a weekly outdoor lesson. Explain your position with two developed reasons, address an opposing view fairly and finish with a conclusion. Do not invent survey results.
Useful words: observation, conditions, boundaries, suitable, nevertheless. Use words only when they fit.

My writing

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Edit and improve | Show what changed

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Read your draft aloud

[ ] My position and audience are clear.
[ ] I develop reasons with relevant examples.
[ ] I represent a reasonable opposing view fairly.
[ ] My response addresses the concern and my conclusion fits.

One focused improvement

Before: They say it is distracting, but they are wrong.
After: Some teachers may worry about distractions. Clear boundaries and a short observation task could help students focus.
Replace a dismissive statement with a fair concern and a response that addresses it.

My before-and-after revision

Original sentence(s):

Improved version:

Explain your change

My change helps the reader because _____

Final writing detective check

[ ] I checked capitals, punctuation and spelling.
[ ] I grouped related ideas in paragraphs where useful.
[ ] I can explain one meaningful change.

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Teacher and parent guide | Answers and teaching support

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Teaching sequence

Use two sessions: read/discuss/plan (about 20–25 minutes), then write/revise (about 20–30 minutes). Adjust to the learner. Rehearse orally before writing; supply extra paper if needed. Models are teaching examples, not scripts to memorise.

Answers and acceptable alternatives

Observing real details can support science discussion. The writer acknowledges difficulty hearing instructions and says the concern matters. A small group area, boundaries and an indoor briefing respond to organisation and communication needs. Staying indoors when unsuitable qualifies the proposal.
Notice task: B names a practical concern without attacking people. A misrepresents motives and does not answer an argument.

Support, challenge and coaching

Support: Discuss one concern such as weather or noise. Rehearse Some may worry… / One way to address this… .
Challenge: Acknowledge a limit that cannot be fully removed and explain why your proposal is still reasonable.
Ask: Would someone with that view recognise your description? Does your response answer their concern?

Record learning and check transfer

For each page 4 skill, record Not yet / With support / Independently. Give one specific next step and let the child make the change. Record adult prompting or scribing.
Later prompt: Should Schools Have a Weekly Creative Project Session?. Hide the model and check whether the target skill transfers. These are classroom practice criteria, not NAPLAN scores.

Curriculum and preparation scope

Supports selected aspects of AC9E5LY06: developing ideas, organising and linking paragraphs, precise vocabulary and text connectives. Guided skill practice for NAPLAN preparation; not an official test or score prediction.
Sources: ACARA v9 Year 5 “Informative text: Bushfires”; nap.edu.au narrative and persuasive writing guides.

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